Employee Script Handout

Part of the “Gen Z at Work” Workplace Navigation & Growth Toolkit

Introduction

This handout provides safe, professional language for everyday workplace situations.

Use it when:

- you’re unsure how something will be received
- emotions are high
- you want to sound confident but respectful
- you want to protect your professional image

These **scripts** are:

- starting points, not rigid lines
- meant to be adapted to your tone
- designed to reduce misunderstandings

You are **not expected** to:

- memorise these
- speak unnaturally
- use them forever

Write Notes

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Clarifying Expectations & Daily Communication

Challenge	Script Options
Asking for clarity.	“I want to make sure I’m aligned. Could you clarify what’s most important here?”
Confirming Understanding.	“Just to confirm my understanding before I proceed…”
Asking a Question without sounding unprepared	“I’ve reviewed this and want to avoid errors. Could you guide me on this part?”
When you need context.	“Could you help me understand the priority and expected outcome?”

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Handling Mistakes, Feedback & Pressure

Challenge	Script Options
When you make a mistake	“I missed this earlier. I understand the impact and will correct it.”
When feedback feels harsh	“I understand the feedback. I’ll work on improving this.”
When you need time to improve	“I’ll focus on this and update you on progress.”
When you don’t fully agree (But want to stay professional)	“I see your point. I’ll reflect on this and align better.”

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Asking for Growth & Learning

Challenges	Script Options
Asking for skill development.	“What skills should I focus on to perform better in this role?”
Expressing interest in growth	“I’m keen to grow here and would appreciate guidance on what to work on next.”
During Reviews	“Could you share areas where I can improve to be more effective?”
When ready for more responsibility	“If there’s an opportunity to take on more responsibility, I’d be happy to try.”

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Setting Boundaries Professionally

Challenge	Script Options
When work comes late in the day	“I’ve noted this. I’ll pick it up first thing tomorrow.”
When you are already stretched	“I want to prioritise this correctly. Could we align on what’s most urgent?”
When you need time	“I’ll need some time to do this well. I’ll update you on timelines.”
When you can’t commit immediately	“Let me review my current priorities and get back to you.”

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Handling Politics & Difficult Interactions

Challenge	Script Options
When someone gosspis	“I’m not fully aware of this, so I’d prefer not to comment.”
When you are asked to take sides	“I’m still understanding the situation. I’ll focus on my responsibilities.”
When you diagree in a Group Setting	“I see the point. May I add a perspective?”
When you are emotionally triggered	“Let me think this through and come back with clarity.”

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How this fits the Toolkit?

Use this handout alongside:

- **Core Toolkit** → how to navigate work life
- **Workplace Reality Cheat Sheet** → how the system operates
- **What Not To Say Cheat Sheet** → what to avoid

This handout helps you:

- be a sound professional under pressure
- protect your image
- grow steadily

It is a **tool for confidence,** not silence.

Guidance on Application & Judgement

This product is designed as a **professional guidance toolkit** for early-career individuals navigating Indian workplaces.

The suggestions, scripts, and examples provided here:

- are **general in nature**
- may not apply to every organisation, role, or situation
- are intended to support **judgment and awareness**, not replace it

Workplaces differ in:

- culture
- leadership styles
- policies
- expectations

Use this toolkit:

- as a **reference**, not a rulebook
- with **discretion and maturity**
- alongside your organisation's policies and norms

This product does **not**:

- encourage confrontation
- promote workplace conflict
- replace HR or People & Culture policies or legal advice

As your experience and credibility grows, your communication style will naturally evolve.

This toolkit is meant to support you **during the early stages of your career**, where clarity and caution are especially valuable.